

CAN LAGOS COMPETE WITH GLOBAL TOURISM CITIES?

A data-backed comparison of Lagos, Dubai, Cairo & Paris across 5 key tourism metrics.

Lagos, Nigeria

Dubai, UAE

Cairo, Egypt

Paris, France

01 - POPULATION



CITY POPULATION

Metro area estimates (millions)

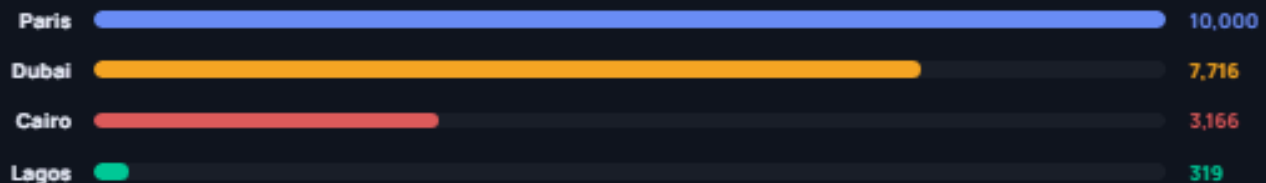


02 - TOURIST ATTRACTIONS



NUMBER OF TOURIST ATTRACTION CENTRES

Documented tourist sites & points of interest

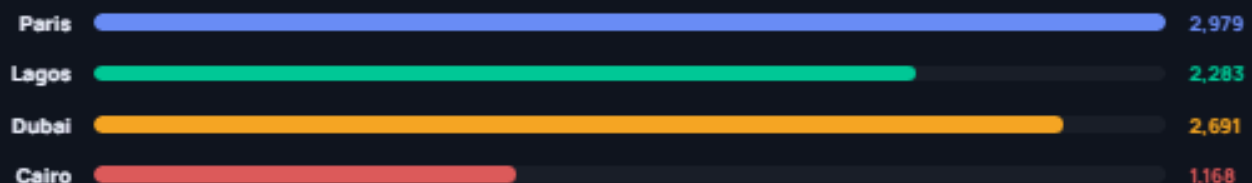


03 - HOTELS



NUMBER OF HOTELS

Registered hotel properties per city





SAFETY INDEX SCORE

Higher score = safer city (scale: 0-100)

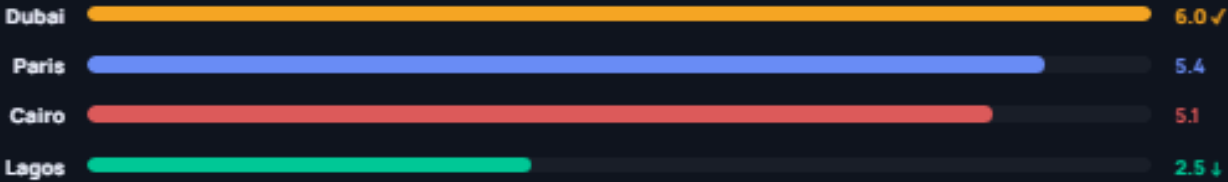


▲ Lagos scores **lowest** in safety among all four cities – a critical gap for tourism growth.



ROAD QUALITY INDEX

WEF Scale (1-7) – Higher score = better road quality



▲ Lagos scores **lowest** on road quality (2.5/7) – far behind Dubai (6.0), Paris (5.4), and Cairo (5.1). Source: WEF via TheGlobalEconomy.com

CITY SNAPSHOT

NG LAGOS

HOTELS: STRONG ✓
ATTRACTIONS: WEAK ✗

Large accommodation base but critically low tourist attractions, safety, and road infrastructure.

AE DUBAI

SAFETY: #1 ✓
ATTRACTIONS: STRONG ✓

Safest city, excellent infrastructure, and thousands of curated tourist experiences.

EG CAIRO

HERITAGE: SOLID ✓
HOTELS: LOW ▲

Rich ancient attractions with moderate safety but limited hotel options relative to its population.

FR PARIS

ATTRACTIONS: #1 ✓
ROADS: STRONG ✓

Leads in tourist attractions. Excellent road quality (5.4/7), second only to Dubai. The benchmark for global tourism cities.



WHAT THE DATA REVEALS

- Lagos has a comparable hotel count to Dubai and Paris – showing real accommodation capacity and investment interest.
- However, with only 319 tourist attractions versus Paris’s 10,000, Lagos’s tourism product is underdeveloped by a wide margin.
- Lagos scores the lowest on safety (31.05) and worst on road quality (348.5) – two factors that directly discourage international tourists.
- The claim has a foundation: Lagos has the population scale and hospitality base. But to truly compete, it must urgently invest in tourist infrastructure, safety, and road quality.
- **Verdict:** Lagos has potential, but is not yet ready to compete with global tourism cities on data alone.



DATA SOURCES

All figures verified from the following references

POPULATION – MACROTRENDS

[NG Lagos](#)[AE Dubai](#)[EG Cairo](#)[FR Paris](#)

TOURIST ATTRACTIONS & HOTELS – TRIPADVISOR

[NG Lagos](#)[AE Dubai](#)[EG Cairo](#)[FR Paris](#)

SAFETY INDEX – NUMBEO

[NG Lagos](#)[AE Dubai](#)[EG Cairo](#)[FR Paris](#)

ROAD QUALITY INDEX – WEF VIA THEGLOBALECONOMY.COM

[NG Lagos](#)[AE Dubai](#)[EG Cairo](#)[FR Paris](#)

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